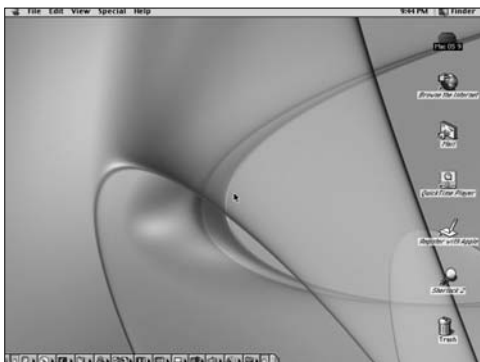


5.1 What is Mac OS X?

People make two very common mistakes about the name “Mac OS X.” The word “Mac” is short for “Macintosh,” and is therefore not supposed to be written “MAC.” The other mistake is that people pronounce the “X” in “Mac OS X” as “ex”; it is supposed to be the number 10, so you pronounce it “ten.”

When Steve Jobs returned to Apple, it was in a dire state, the reason being that the Mac OS was very outdated and hadn’t seen a revision in years. Therefore, when Apple announced Mac OS X, it was met with an enthusiasm that can



The Classic Mac operating system

hardly be overstated. The Apple faithful had been waiting fifteen years for a worthy successor to the classic Mac operating system. Several had even jumped the gun and switched to the only commercial alternative, the Windows OS from Microsoft. Mac OS X had been through a series of code names in the development stages—Taligent, Copland, Rhapsody, and Cheetah. The last was supposed to be just an internal code name, but it sounded cool enough as a branding for the final version, so it stayed on when the product left the labs.

OS X was supposed to regain some of the lost market share for Apple, the market share that was lost to Windows 95 when it was released in 1995. Consumers flocked to Windows 95 in droves. Sure, it lacked the fine polish of the Mac OS, but it was cheaper and compatible with all IBM PC clones. It wasn’t “insanely great,” but for most people, it did the job. After all previous attempts at